

LEAVE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

An Agile Business Analysis Case Study

From requirements to release: designing a role-based leave platform for Employees, Managers, and HR

Prepared by

Business Analyst | Agile / Scrum

Methodology: Scrum • Tool: Jira • Deliverables: 12 User Stories, Wireframes, Activity Diagrams

Project Overview

The Leave Management System (LMS) is a role-based web and mobile application built to replace a manual, paper-driven leave process with a single digital workflow. Employees apply for leave and track balances in real time; managers review and act on requests without leaving their dashboard; and HR configures policy, resolves exceptions, and reports on usage across the organization.

I led this project as the Business Analyst, owning requirements gathering, user story writing, wireframing, and sprint planning from kickoff through to a fully documented, development-ready backlog.

Why It Mattered

- Manual leave tracking led to approval delays, balance errors, and no audit trail.
- Managers had no consolidated view of team availability, causing scheduling conflicts.
- HR lacked a fast way to enforce policy consistently or report on leave trends.

The LMS was scoped to solve all three problems in a single, auditable system — reducing manual effort, improving compliance, and giving every role real-time visibility.

Project Goals

- Enable employees to apply for leave through a simple, validated digital form.
- Provide real-time visibility into leave balances and request status.
- Let managers approve or reject requests efficiently, with instant notifications.
- Give HR control to configure leave types, rules, and policy overrides.
- Deliver department-level, exportable reporting for audits and trend analysis.
- Improve organization-wide transparency, compliance, and operational efficiency.

User Roles

The system was scoped around three role types, each with a distinct set of permissions and workflows:

Employee	Apply for leave, view balances, modify or cancel pending requests, and track approval status.
Manager	Review team leave requests, approve or reject, view the team calendar, and receive instant notifications.
HR / Admin	Configure leave types and rules, override decisions when needed, generate reports, and view audit logs.

Tools & Methodology

- Development Approach: Agile, Scrum-based, delivered across two sprints.
- Project Management: Jira — backlog management, user stories, and sprint planning.
- Modelling: Wireframes for UI, activity diagrams for process flow, flowcharts for workflow visualization.
- Deliverables: 12 functional user stories (LMS-01 to LMS-12), a full wireframe set, and activity-flow diagrams for every core process.

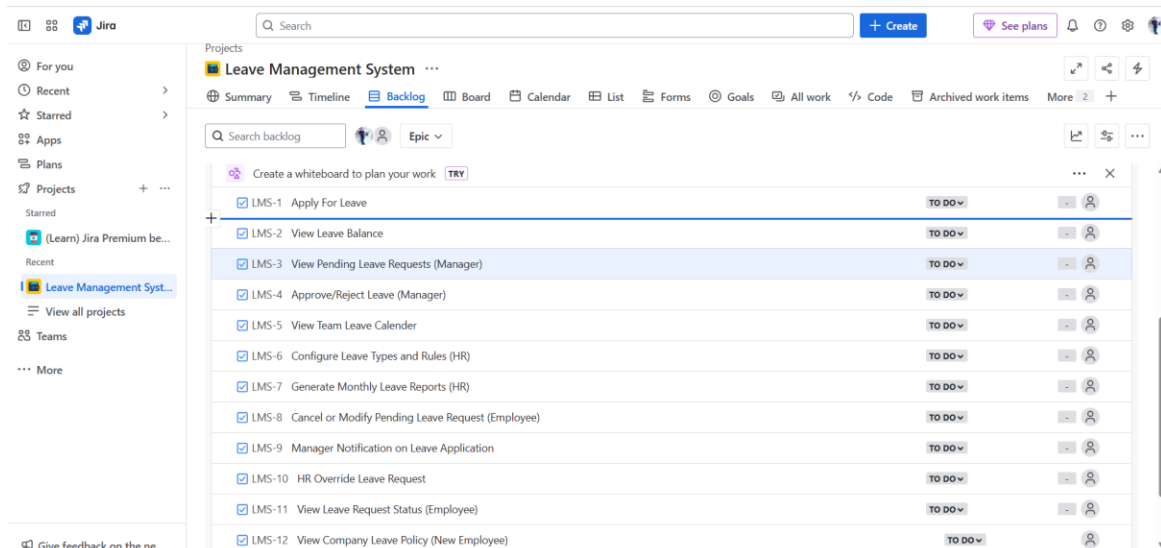
Feature Status Overview

Twelve user stories covered the full leave lifecycle. Eight were fully delivered, two carried into a later iteration, and two remained in the backlog for a following release.

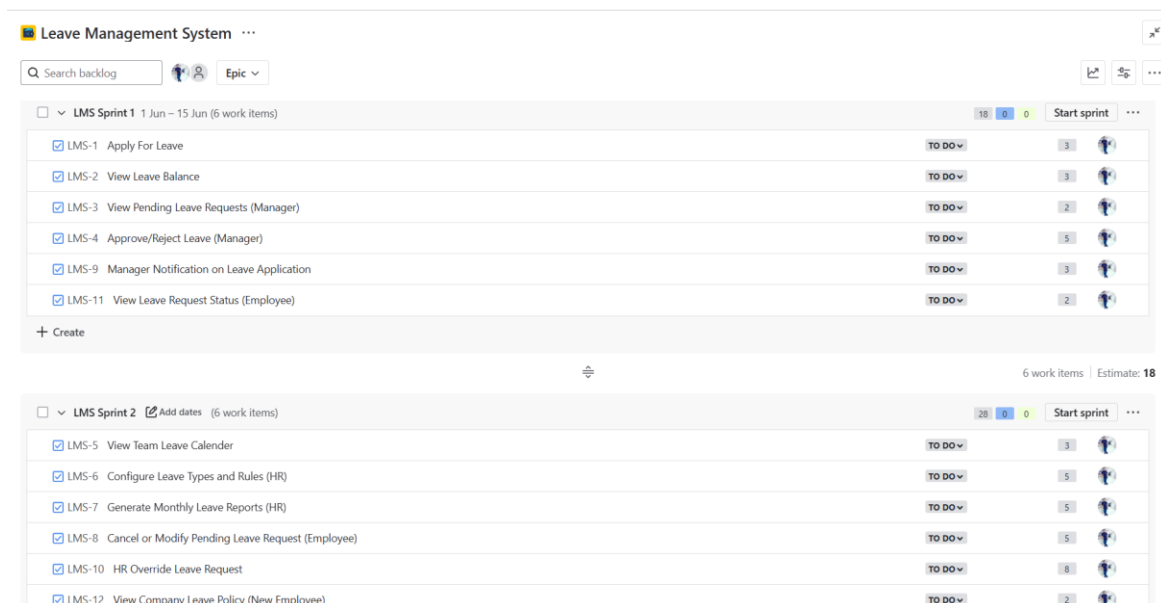
ID	Feature	Status	Points
LMS-01	Apply for Leave	Complete	3
LMS-02	View Leave Balance	Complete	2
LMS-03	View Pending Leave Requests (Manager)	To-Do	2
LMS-04	Approve/Reject Leave	Complete	5
LMS-05	View Team Leave Calendar	In Progress	3
LMS-06	Configure Leave Types and Rules	In Progress	5
LMS-07	Generate Monthly Leave Reports	Complete	5
LMS-08	Cancel or Modify Leave Request	Complete	5
LMS-09	Manager Notification on Leave	Complete	3
LMS-10	HR Override Leave Request	Complete	8
LMS-11	View Leave Request Status	Complete	2
LMS-12	View Company Leave Policy	To-Do	2

Agile Delivery in Jira

All 12 stories were logged as an epic in Jira and sequenced into two sprints. Sprint 1 prioritized the core employee-facing loop — applying for leave, checking balances, and tracking status — plus the manager actions needed to close that loop. Sprint 2 layered on team visibility, HR configuration, and reporting.



Jira backlog for the Leave Management System epic, LMS-01 through LMS-12.



Two-sprint delivery plan: Sprint 1 covers employee-facing flows (18 points); Sprint 2 covers manager and HR workflows (28 points).

Key User Stories & Wireframes

A closer look at five of the twelve stories — spanning all three roles — shows how each requirement translated directly into a validated, development-ready screen.

LMS-01 Apply for Leave

As an employee, I want to apply for leave through an online form, so that I can request time off without going through a manual process.

- Form captures leave type, start/end dates, auto-calculated day count, and a mandatory reason.
- System blocks past dates and requests exceeding the available balance for that leave type.

- On submission: status is set to Pending Approval, the manager is notified, and the request is logged to history.

The mockup shows a mobile app interface for applying for leave. It features a title 'Apply for Leave' at the top. Below the title are several input fields: 'Leave Type' with a dropdown menu showing 'Select', 'Start Date' and 'End Date' with calendar icons, 'Number of Days' with a text input, and 'Reason for leave:' with a larger text area. Below these fields is an 'Error message' label and a 'Submit' button. At the bottom of the form, a message states 'Leave request submitted successfully.' The app's bottom navigation bar is visible with icons for home, menu, and other functions.

LMS-02 View Leave Balance

As an employee, I want to view my remaining leave balance, so that I can plan my vacations or leaves accordingly.

- Balances are grouped by leave type and update automatically on approval, accrual, or carry-forward.
- Employees can download the balance summary as PDF or Excel.
- Every balance change is audit-logged with a timestamp and trigger source.

The mockup shows a mobile app interface for viewing leave balance. It features a title 'Leave Balance' with an information icon (i) to its right. Below the title is a table with two columns: 'Leave Type' and 'Days Remaining'. The table contains three rows of data: 'Casual' with 4 days, 'Sick' with 2 days, and 'Earned' with 5 days. Below the table is a 'Download' button. The app's bottom navigation bar is visible with icons for home, menu, and other functions.

Leave Type	Days Remaining
Casual	4
Sick	2
Earned	5

LMS-04 Approve / Reject Leave (Manager)

As a manager, I want to approve or reject leave requests so that I can manage team availability efficiently.

- Approve or reject is available from the pending-request list or the detailed view.
- Rejection requires a mandatory reason; both actions notify the employee and lock the request as read-only.
- Every decision is timestamped and logged with the manager's identity for audit purposes.

The image shows a mobile application interface for managing leave requests. The screen is titled "Approve/Reject Leave" with an information icon. Below the title, there is a section for "Employee Name" which is currently empty. Underneath, there is a "Leave Status" dropdown menu showing "Leave Status" with a downward arrow. Below that is a "Reason" section with a large text input area. At the bottom of the form are two buttons: "Approve" and "Reject". The interface is displayed on a smartphone frame with a home indicator at the bottom.

LMS-07 Generate Monthly Leave Reports (HR)

As an HR user, I want to generate downloadable monthly leave reports for departments so that I can analyze usage trends and ensure compliance.

- Filterable by date range, department, and leave type.
- Report includes department-wise summaries, approved-vs-rejected counts, and top leave takers.
- Exportable to Excel, PDF, or directly by email; every export is audit-logged.



LMS-10 HR Override Leave Request

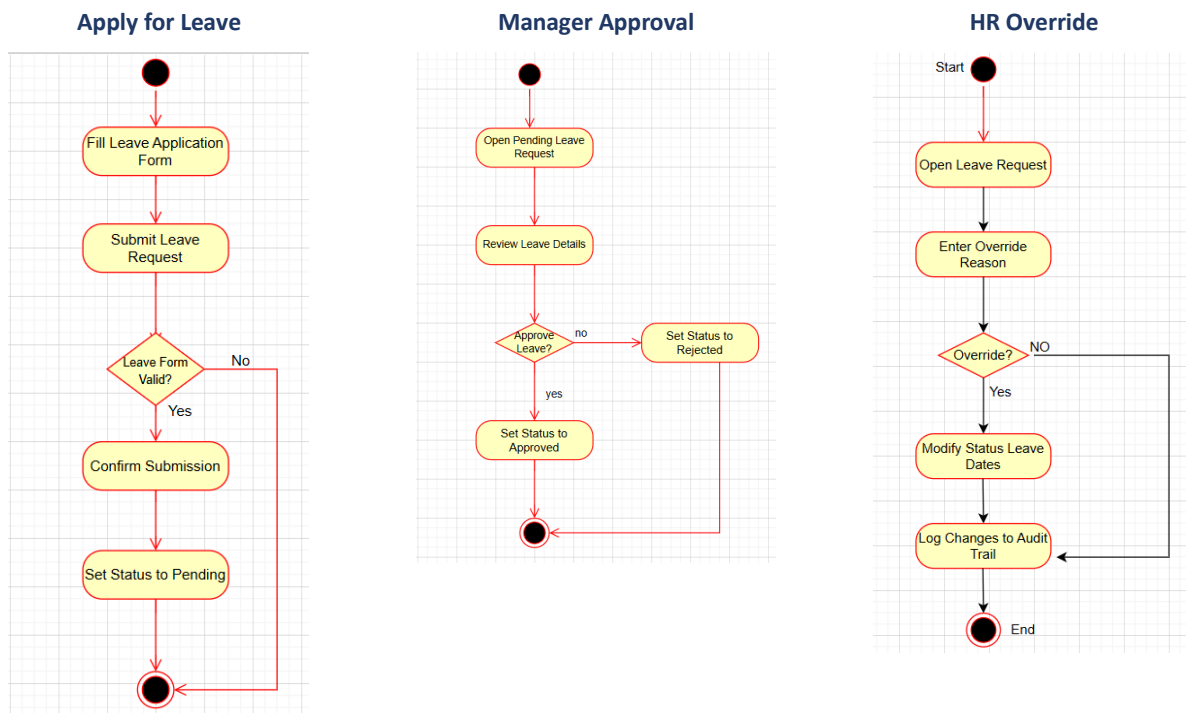
As an HR user, I want to override a leave request in special cases so that I can correct discrepancies or apply exceptions.

- Restricted to HR users; supports changing status or editing leave dates/type.
- A mandatory override reason is required before submission.
- Every override logs previous values, updated values, timestamp, and HR identity, and flags the request as 'Modified by HR.'

The 'HR Override Leave Request' interface shows the name 'John Doe' at the top. Below it, the 'Dates' are 'May 5, 2024 - May 8 2024', the 'Leave' type is 'Casual', and the 'Status' is 'Rejected'. There are buttons for 'Change Status' and 'Edit Dates'. Below these, there is a 'Reason for Override' section with a text input field and a 'Confirm' button.

Process Flows

Activity diagrams mapped the decision logic behind each core workflow, giving developers an unambiguous spec for validation rules, branching, and system state changes.



Three of the six activity flows produced for the project: employee submission, manager decision, and HR exception handling.

My Role & Contributions

As the Business Analyst driving this project end-to-end, I owned the path from raw stakeholder need to a development-ready backlog:

- Gathered and documented requirements directly from employees, managers, and HR stakeholders.
- Wrote 12 detailed user stories, each with explicit, testable acceptance criteria.
- Designed wireframes and activity-flow diagrams for every core functionality.
- Built and prioritized the Jira backlog, estimated story points, and sequenced delivery across two sprints.
- Partnered with developers and testers throughout to clarify scope and resolve ambiguity.
- Maintained Agile ceremonies and documentation to keep progress traceable sprint over sprint.

Lessons Learned

- Explicit, testable acceptance criteria removed ambiguity before development began.
- Wireframes and activity diagrams gave non-technical stakeholders a shared, concrete reference point.
- Splitting delivery into two role-focused sprints made feedback faster and prioritization easier to defend.

Conclusion & Future Enhancements

The LMS project replaced a manual, error-prone leave process with a centralized, auditable system that gives employees, managers, and HR real-time visibility into leave status and policy. The Agile approach — incremental delivery, continuous stakeholder feedback, and a fully traceable backlog — kept the scope tight and the requirements verifiable at every step.

Planned next steps include payroll integration, a native mobile app, and analytics for organization-wide leave trends.